Lead Broker Blueprint

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Module 8

Continued Learning

What this module does

Module 8 is the closer. After seven modules of foundation, vertical landscape, regulatory framework, buyer-side operations, generation-side mechanics, operational tooling, and the readiness-and-decision framework — what's left is the question of where to go next.

The lead-gen industry has a substantial public conversation. Trade publications, podcasts, conferences, and operator-authored content publish thousands of useful pages a year. The goal of this module is to point you at the highest-yield places to continue learning, and to set up the quarterly regulatory-update rhythm the rest of the course depends on.

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Module 8 overview

Six lessons:

- 8.1 Industry publications, podcasts, conferences.
- 8.2 Communities — Slack / Discord / Reddit / LinkedIn.
- 8.3 Key people to follow.
- 8.4 Books and longer-form resources.
- 8.5 How to keep up with regulation.
- 8.6 Course wrap-up and how to give honest feedback.

One deliverable: the Resource Library — a PDF with every link, organized for quick reference.

Lesson 8.1 — Industry publications, podcasts, conferences

> **Learning objective**
> Identify the conferences, publications, and podcasts a serious operator follows. Triage them by signal-to-noise ratio so you can subscribe to the highest-yield ones without drowning.

Conferences

- LeadsCon. The dominant general lead-generation conference. Two events per year (typically Vegas in March and an additional event). Mix of operators, buyers, vendors. Worth attending in person at least once; recordings often available.
- Performance Marketing Summit (PMS). General performance-marketing focus; broader than lead-gen, but relevant tracks.
- Affiliate Summit / Affiliate Summit West. Affiliate ecosystem; useful if your supply or demand has affiliate components.
- Vertical-specific: Mass Torts Made Perfect (MTMP — legal mass tort); Service World Expo (HVAC/plumbing); ITA Insurance Marketing & Tech Summit; National Association of Mortgage Brokers events; Inman Connect (real estate).

Publications and trade press

- LeadsCouncil — the trade association's published research and operator surveys.
- Performance Marketing Association — events and published reports.
- MarTech Today and Search Engine Land — paid-acquisition coverage relevant to lead-gen.
- AdExchanger — programmatic and ad-tech coverage; useful for understanding the upstream economics.

Podcasts

- Lead Generation podcast (Brian Schaffer; legal-leaning).
- The Affiliate Engine (affiliate-network operators).
- Marketing Underground (Wes Schaeffer; operator commentary).
- Vertical-specific: Mass Torts podcasts; HomeServiceMVP for trades; insurance-specific podcasts via ITA.

Honest note: lead-generation podcast content varies widely in quality. The signal-to-noise ratio improves substantially when you subscribe to 2-3 you find genuinely useful and skip the rest.

Sources

- LeadsCon.com (event calendars and recorded sessions).
- Performance Marketing Association (pmassociation.com).
- LeadsCouncil (leadscouncil.org).

Lesson 8.2 — Communities

> **Learning objective**
> Find the working communities where operators discuss real problems. Pick 1-2 to participate in actively rather than lurking in twelve.

Slack / Discord communities

- LeadsCouncil member Slack — primary general operator community; access through membership.
- Vertical-specific Slacks for home services (HVAC operator groups, Service Roundtable members area), legal (mass-tort firm peer groups via MTMP), and insurance (IMC member groups).
- MartechSlack and DemandGen Slack for B2B-flavored operators.

Reddit communities

- r/marketing, r/Entrepreneur — broad signal; some lead-gen threads buried in general traffic.
- r/PPC, r/SEO, r/FacebookAds — channel-specific operator discussions.
- Vertical subreddits where the BUYER is the audience (r/PIlawyers, r/HVAC, r/Insurance) — useful for understanding the buyer mindset, not for finding peer operators.

LinkedIn groups and individual operators

- LinkedIn has shifted toward individual operator content rather than group discussion. Following specific operators (see Lesson 8.3) yields more signal than joining groups.

Active participation, not passive

Operators who post substantively in communities — asking specific questions, sharing problems, posting case studies (consent-compliant) — get vastly more value from communities than operators who lurk. Pick 1-2 communities; commit to posting once a month for six months; see what happens.

Sources

- LeadsCouncil membership and community page.
- Industry-specific peer groups (typically gated to member-association attendees).

Lesson 8.3 — Key people to follow

> **Learning objective**
> Build a follow-list of operators, analysts, regulators, and lawyers who publish useful content. Pick 8-15 to follow actively; ignore the rest.

Operators publishing substantive content

This list is necessarily snapshot-in-time; check who's still publishing actively before subscribing. The author focuses on operators who name specific numbers, specific verticals, and specific tactics — and who don't make income claims.

- LeadsCouncil board members and active speakers at LeadsCon.
- Vertical-specialist consultants (search the speaker rosters of vertical-specific conferences).
- LinkedIn operators tagged in #leadgeneration, #performancemarketing discussions (filter for substantive content, not engagement bait).

Lawyers who publish substantively on TCPA / FTC / lead-gen regulation

- Klein Moynihan Turco — TCPA practice; blog at kleinmoynihan.com.
- Eversheds Sutherland — broad consumer-finance and TCPA coverage.
- Squire Patton Boggs — TCPA practice; consumer-finance enforcement.
- Manatt — health-care, telehealth, and FTC enforcement.
- Womble Bond Dickinson — insurance industry-specific.

Regulators (for staying current on enforcement priorities)

- FTC Bureau of Consumer Protection — press releases and consent decrees are the primary signal of FTC priorities.
- FCC Consumer and Governmental Affairs Bureau — TCPA-related rulemakings and consent decrees.
- CFPB — RESPA, UDAAP, and consumer-finance enforcement.
- State attorneys general — vertical-specific; California, New York, Massachusetts, and Texas AGs are most active in consumer protection.

Analysts and researchers

- Forrester, eMarketer — broad performance-marketing analysis.
- Industry-specific analysts: J.D. Power (insurance), Kantar (advertising), Nielsen (media).

How to maintain the list

Review your follow-list quarterly. Drop anyone whose content has drifted into self-promotion without substance. Add when you find new substantive sources. The list should stay small (8-15); a 50-person follow-list is a sign you're not reading any of them carefully.

Sources

- The respective firms' websites and publication archives.
- LinkedIn follow lists curated against the criteria above.

Lesson 8.4 — Books and longer-form resources

> **Learning objective**
> Recognize the books and longer-form resources that hold up. Distinguish from short-form operator content that goes stale fast.

Marketing and performance-marketing

- "Hacking Growth" (Sean Ellis, Morgan Brown) — growth methodology applicable to lead generation.
- "Traction" (Gabriel Weinberg, Justin Mares) — 19 channels framework; useful for thinking about traffic-source diversification.
- "The Adweek Copywriting Handbook" (Joseph Sugarman) — copywriting fundamentals. Old but durable.

Validation and lean methodology

- "The Lean Startup" (Eric Ries) — validation thinking applicable to vertical selection and experimentation.
- "The Mom Test" (Rob Fitzpatrick) — how to do useful customer-development conversations. Directly applicable to buyer-side discovery.

Sales and negotiation

- "SPIN Selling" (Neil Rackham) — situation-problem-implication-need framework. Useful for buyer-side conversations.
- "Never Split the Difference" (Chris Voss) — negotiation tactics; useful for LPA negotiation.
- "Getting to Yes" (Roger Fisher, William Ury) — principled negotiation foundation.

Industry-specific

- There is no single canonical book on lead brokering specifically. The industry's longer-form knowledge lives in trade publication archives, conference recordings, and law-firm publications rather than in books. The lack of a canonical text is one of the reasons a course like this one exists.

On compliance and legal context

- Klein Moynihan Turco's published guides on TCPA compliance (free PDFs on their site).
- The IAPP Privacy Law Library (paid) for state privacy law tracking.

- ABA Section on Antitrust and ABA Section on Litigation publications, when they cover lead-gen-relevant topics.

Sources

- Listed authors and publishers; verify current editions.
- Law-firm and trade-association publications referenced throughout the course.

Lesson 8.5 — How to keep up with regulation

> **Learning objective**
> Build a quarterly regulatory-update process. Identify the primary sources to monitor.

What to monitor

Federal

- FCC dockets relevant to TCPA (especially CG Docket No. 02-278).
- FTC press releases, rulemakings, and consent decrees.
- CFPB enforcement actions and rule announcements.
- Major federal court decisions on TCPA, FTC, and consumer-finance regulation.

State

- State attorney general consumer-protection enforcement (especially CA, NY, TX, MA).
- State privacy laws — new enactments and effective-date changes.
- State insurance department bulletins (if you operate in insurance).
- State bar advertising rule changes (if you operate in legal).

Industry self-regulatory

- LeadsCouncil and Performance Marketing Association code-of-conduct updates.
- CMS Medicare Communications & Marketing Guidelines (annual).

The quarterly process

1. Schedule a recurring 2-hour block once per quarter for regulatory review.
2. Re-read the most recent quarter's law-firm-published TCPA/FTC alerts (Klein Moynihan Turco, Eversheds Sutherland, Squire Patton Boggs, Manatt).
3. Check FTC and FCC press-release archives for the quarter.
4. Review your compliance checklist (Module 3 deliverable) against the new developments. Flag any items that need re-verification.
5. Update your operation: scripts, disclosures, vendor configurations as needed.
6. Document the review: what you found, what you changed, what you didn't change and why.

The course's quarterly update

This course commits to a quarterly refresh of Module 3 (the regulatory module) and the compliance checklist. The first quarterly update after publication is scheduled for [TBD per launch date]. The updates

are sent via email to anyone who purchased the course; major regulatory shifts get an interstitial update outside the quarterly cycle.

Sources

- FCC.gov dockets and consumer-affairs pages.
- FTC.gov press releases and rule pages.
- CFPB.gov enforcement and rules pages.
- Law-firm TCPA/FTC blogs listed above.

Lesson 8.6 — Course wrap-up and how to give honest feedback

> **Learning objective**
> Apply the standing disclosures to your own usage of the course. Use the refund policy and the feedback channel if either is appropriate.

What you've covered

- Module 1 — What lead brokering actually is. Vocabulary, four-player structure, business models, brief history, why the industry exists.
- Module 2 — The vertical landscape. Six-factor evaluation framework; seven vertical landscapes; vertical-selection exercise.
- Module 3 — The regulatory landscape. Thirteen lessons on TCPA, FCC, FTC, TSR, CAN-SPAM, FCRA, state privacy, vertical-specific regulation, plus the compliance checklist.
- Module 4 — The buyer side. Buyer profiles, channels, LPA structure, pricing-model matching, delivery, disputes, the new-vendor conversation.
- Module 5 — The lead generation side. Traffic sources, paid search and social, SEO, landing-page anatomy, intake and qualification, unit economics.
- Module 6 — Operations and tooling. Tech stack, distribution platforms, call tracking, consent capture, team structure, operational pitfalls.
- Module 7 — Starting from zero. Readiness assessment, capital scenarios, buyer-first sequencing, validation methodology, failure modes, when to walk away.
- Module 8 — Continued learning. Where to go next.

The four marketing lines this course doesn't cross

7. No income claims, mine or implied.
8. No fake testimonials or AI-generated reviews (FTC Reviews Rule, effective October 21, 2024).
9. No fake scarcity, fake countdowns, or manufactured urgency.
10. Real 30-day no-questions refund policy.

The refund policy

If this course wasn't useful to you, the refund policy is real. Email [refund@...] within 30 days of purchase. No questions, no friction. The author would rather refund a buyer who isn't getting value than have the course oversold to people for whom it wasn't right.

How to give honest feedback

Three forms of feedback the author wants:

- Errors or out-of-date claims. If a regulation has moved, a citation has gone stale, or a number is wrong, flag it via the feedback form linked in the resource library. The quarterly update cycle is built around this feedback.
- Section-level clarity. If a lesson didn't land — too dense, too thin, missing the actual question you had — say so. The course is in v1.0; substantive feedback will shape v1.1 and beyond.
- Vertical-specific gaps. If you went deep into a vertical and found the coverage thin, point at the gap. The vertical depth in Module 2 is necessarily broad-then-shallow; reader feedback shapes which sub-verticals deserve more depth in future revisions.

Closing — the author's positioning, restated

This is a research-based primer, not a get-rich playbook. The author is a curriculum builder, not a multi-million-dollar lead-gen operator. The course's value is that it saves the buyer 50+ hours of independent research and gives them a structured, honest picture of the industry. It is not a substitute for legal advice in your jurisdiction, vertical-specific counsel, or your own validation work.

If the course earned your money, the most useful thing you can do is succeed in this business and report back what was useful or not. If it didn't, please use the refund policy and tell me why.

Good luck.

> **Final standing disclosures**
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> Research-based primer; not legal, financial, or business advice for your situation. Regulations cited are current as of May 2026 and will be re-researched quarterly. No income claims are made or implied. Real 30-day refund policy. All testimonials, when they exist, are real and disclosed.